Creating a Zero-Spend Budget in AWS

Aim: To create an AWS zero-spend budget that alerts you when any charges occur.

Steps

1. Sign in to the AWS Management Console.

2. Search for **Billing and Cost Management** and open it.

3. Select **Budgets**, then click **Create budget**.

4. Choose **Use a template (simplified)**.

5. Select **Zero spend budget** as the template.

AWS Budgets is used to track your costs and send alerts when spending crosses a limit.

Step 2 — Configure and create the budget

1. Enter the budget name **My Zero-Spend Budget**.

2. Enter your email address to receive alerts.

3. Review the settings. The budget amount is **$1.00** (alerts at $0.01).

4. Click **Create budget**.

Note: A zero-spend budget emails you as soon as your spend goes above the free tier.

Step 3 — Verify the budget

1. AWS shows a green success message.

2. The budget appears in the Budgets list.

3. Check **Thresholds: OK** and **Health status: Healthy**.

4. Spend data can take up to 24 hours to populate.

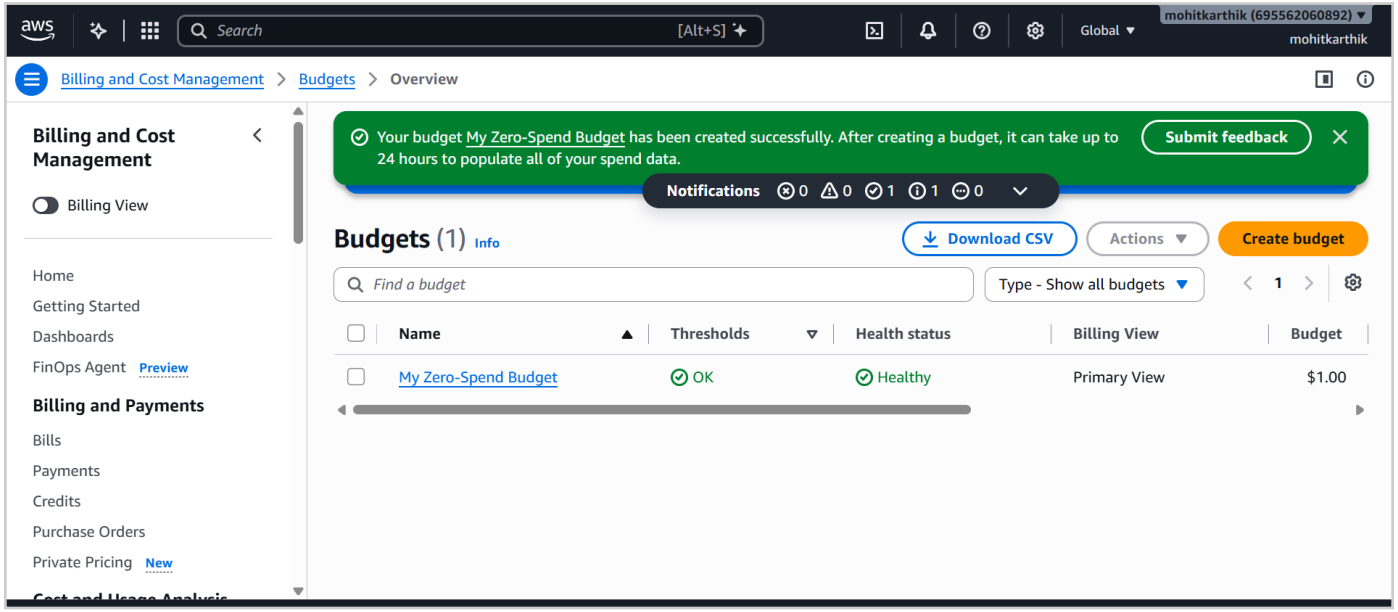


Figure 1: Budgets page showing My Zero-Spend Budget created successfully.

Result: The zero-spend budget **My Zero-Spend Budget** was created and is healthy.

Tip: Check your email for alerts and review the budget regularly.